

A NEW KIND OF JOBS REPORT

The jobs report built only for white-collar workers.

The monthly jobs number covers 170 million workers. It hides what's happening to professionals. We went into the Census data ourselves.

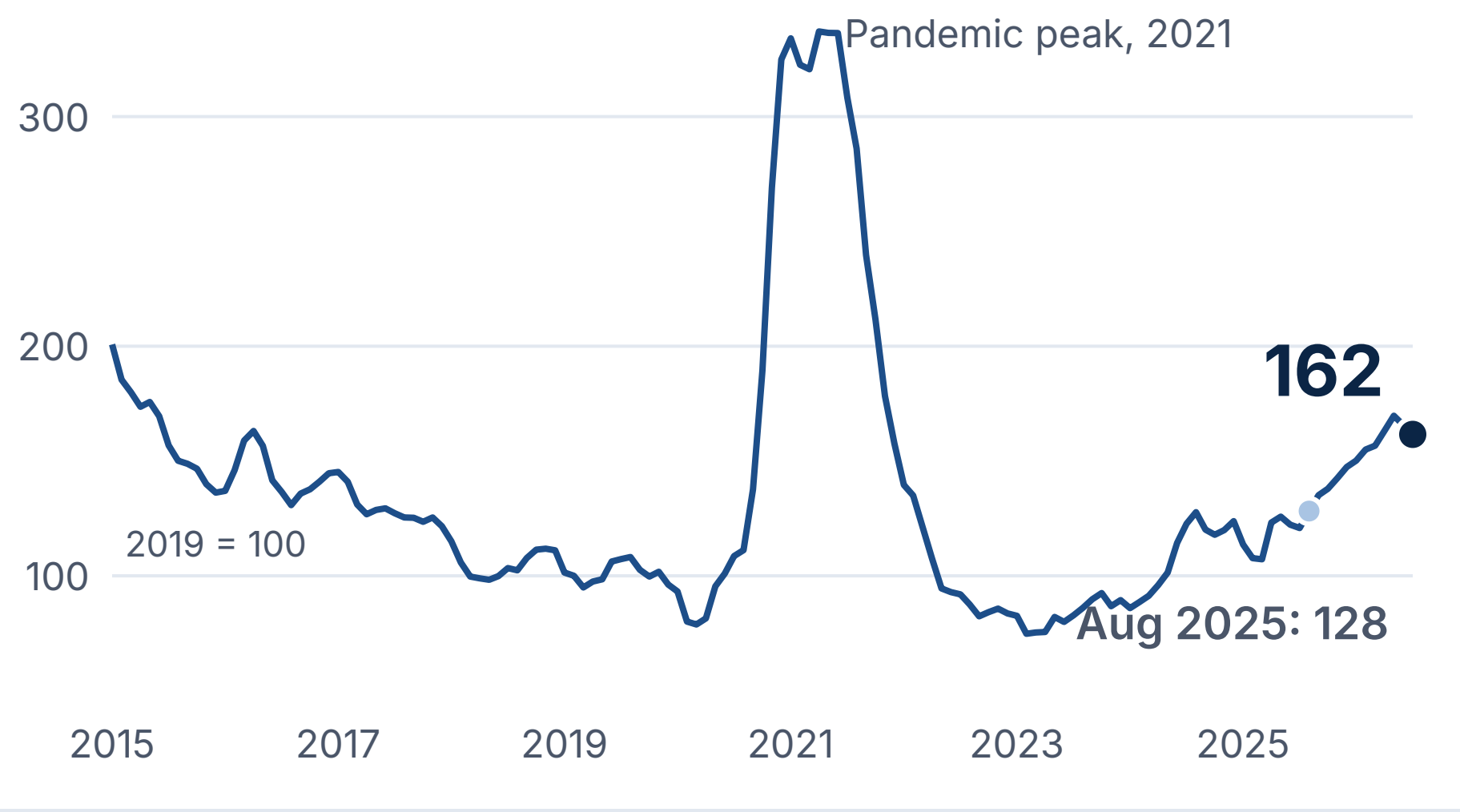
8 findings for September 2026 →

NextChapter Displacement Report · Original analysis of Census Current Population Survey microdata, with margins of error.

1 · THE INDEX

Professionals' long-term unemployment is more than 50% above 2019

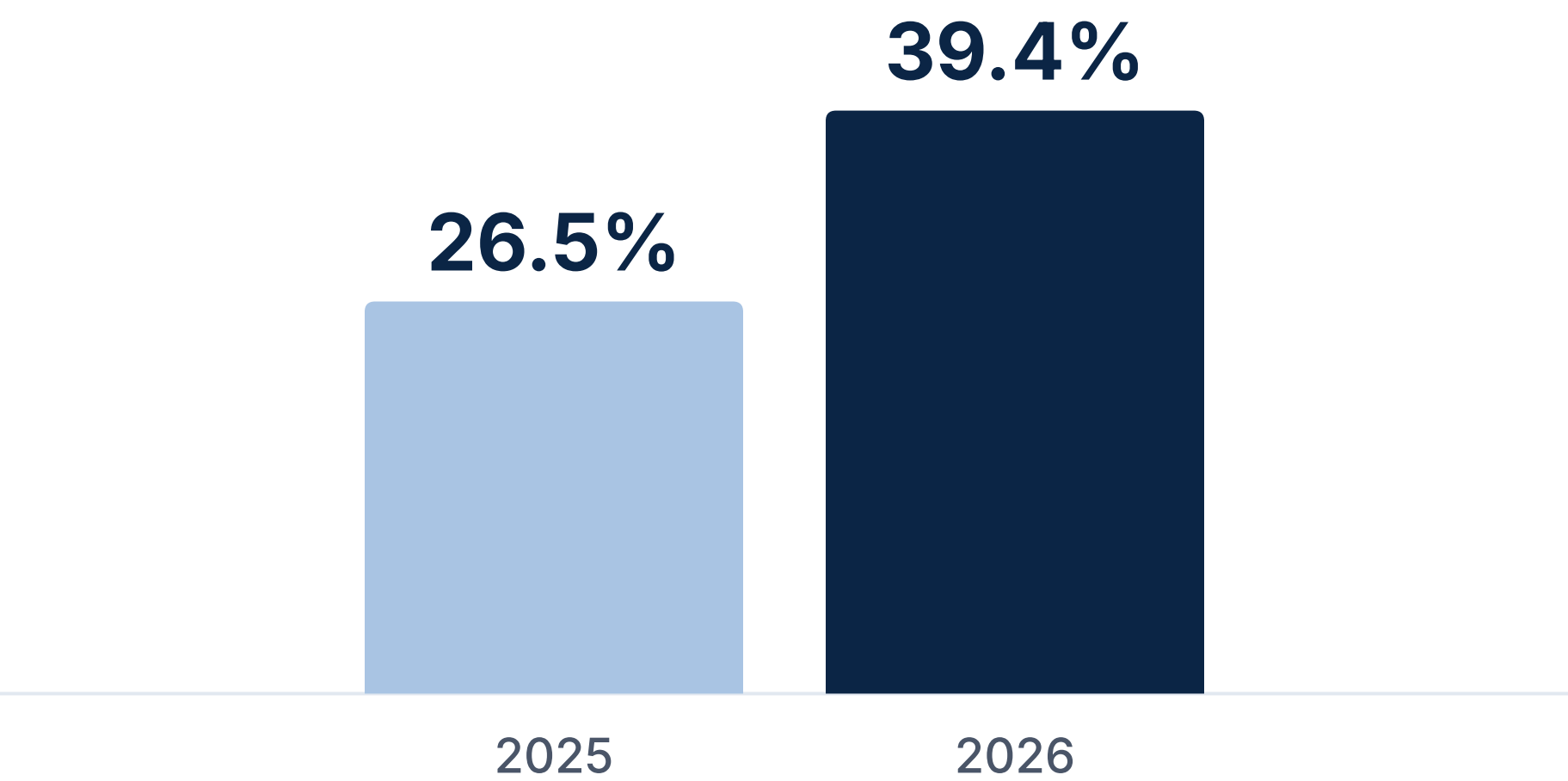
NextChapter White-Collar Long-Term Unemployment Index, seasonally adjusted, 3-month average



Index of white-collar workers unemployed 27+ weeks as a share of the white-collar labor force. 2019 average = 100. October 2025 not collected (shutdown). Source: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata.

2 · AGE

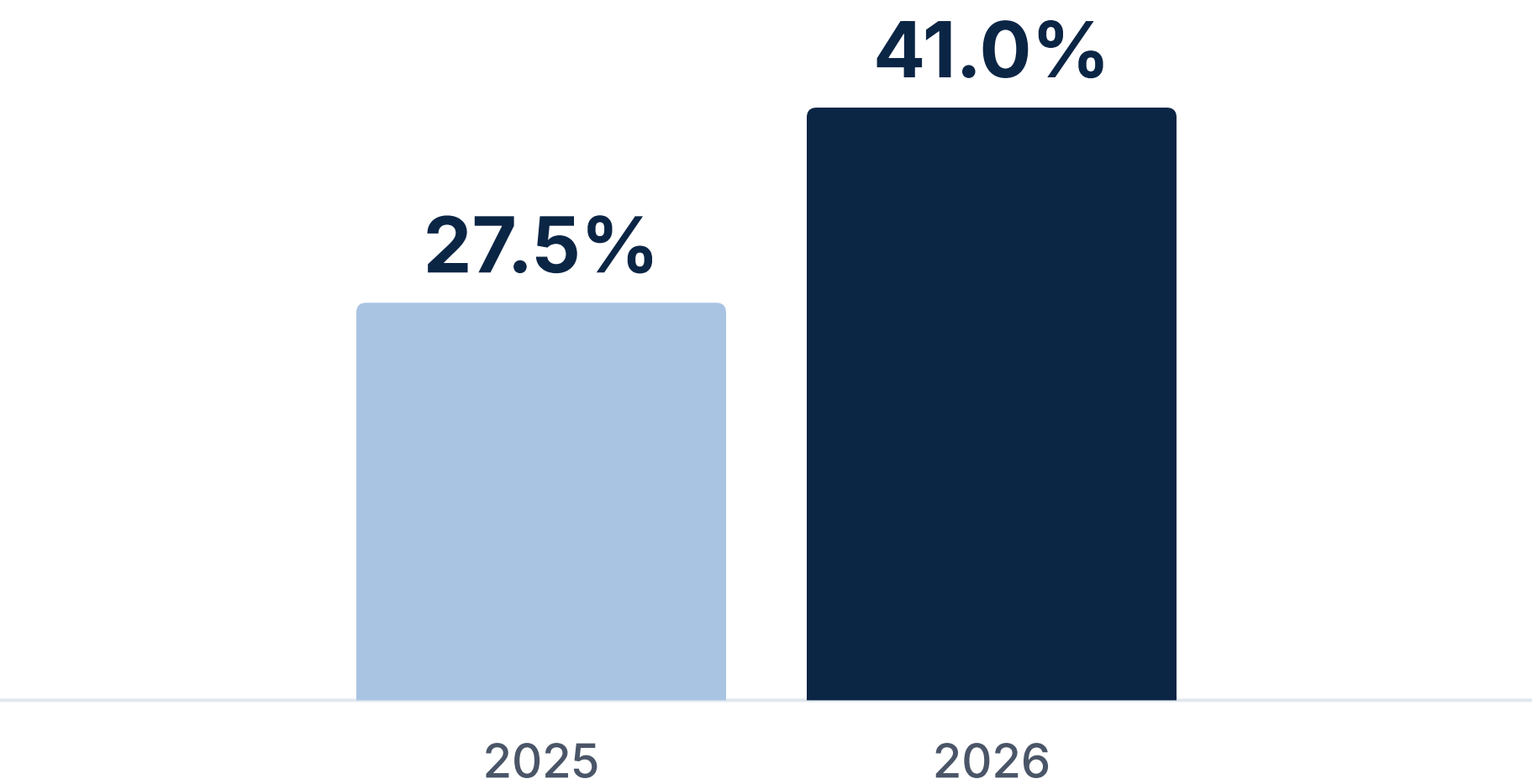
39% of unemployed professionals aged 55–64 have been looking 6+ months



Share of unemployed white-collar workers aged 55–64 out 27+ weeks, January–August average, not seasonally adjusted. Change exceeds our approximate 90% margin of error. Source: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata.

3 · TECH

Tech workers are stuck longest: 41% out 6+ months



Share of unemployed computer and mathematical workers out 27+ weeks, January–August average. Change exceeds our approximate 90% margin of error. Source: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata.

4 · AI AND LAYOFFS

AI is cited in 21% of announced cuts, but only 9% of formal SEC filings

21%

of workers in announced 2026 job cuts, where companies named AI as the reason

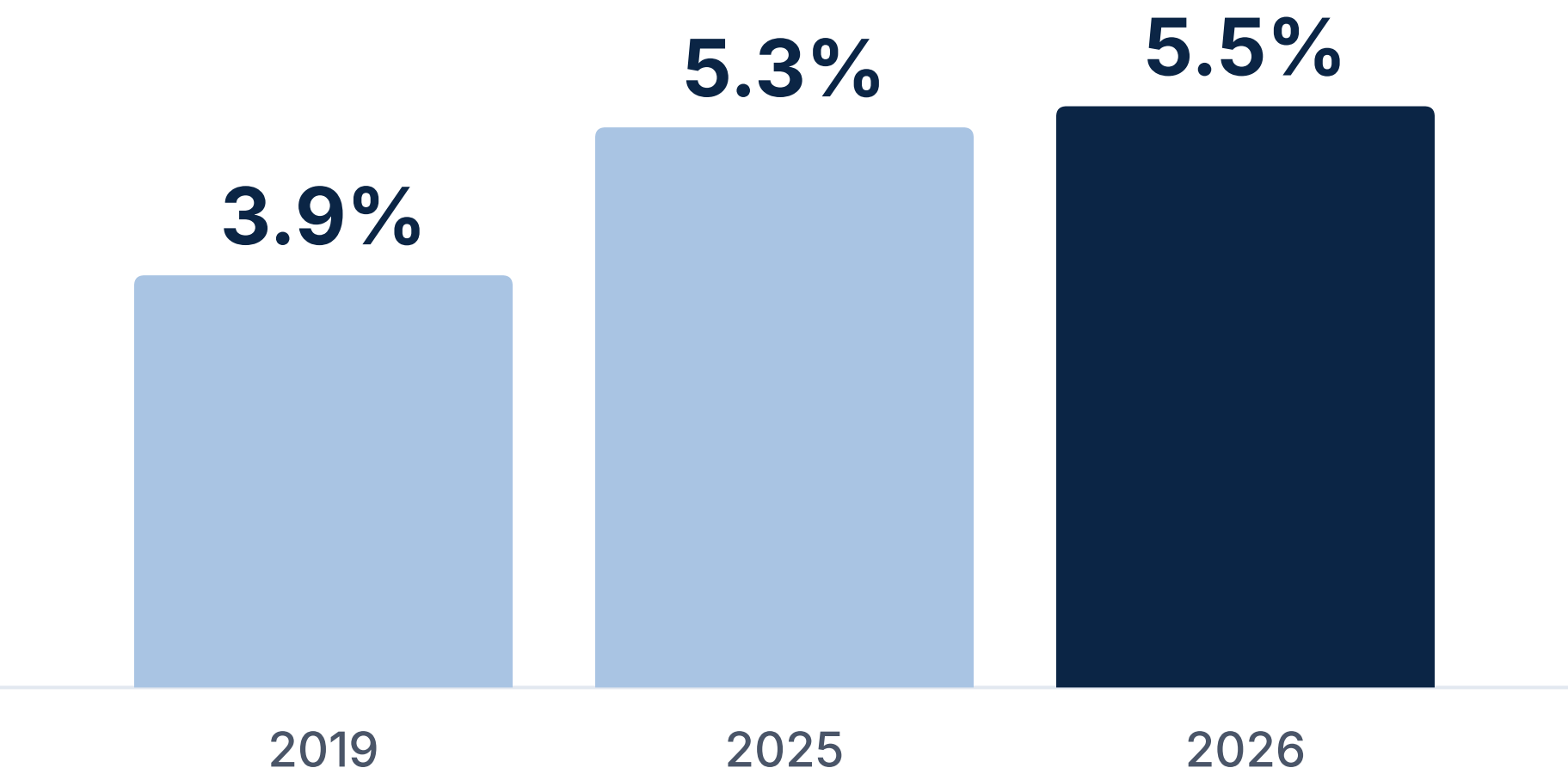
9%

of formal SEC restructuring filings that cite AI (16 of 170)

Announced cuts: share of workers in 2026 job-cut announcements where AI was the stated reason (Challenger, Gray & Christmas). Filings: 16 of 170 SEC 8-K Item 2.05 restructuring filings, Jan–Sep 2026, that cite AI in the restructuring disclosure itself, hand-read by NextChapter. Units differ (workers vs. filings).

5 · NEW GRADUATES

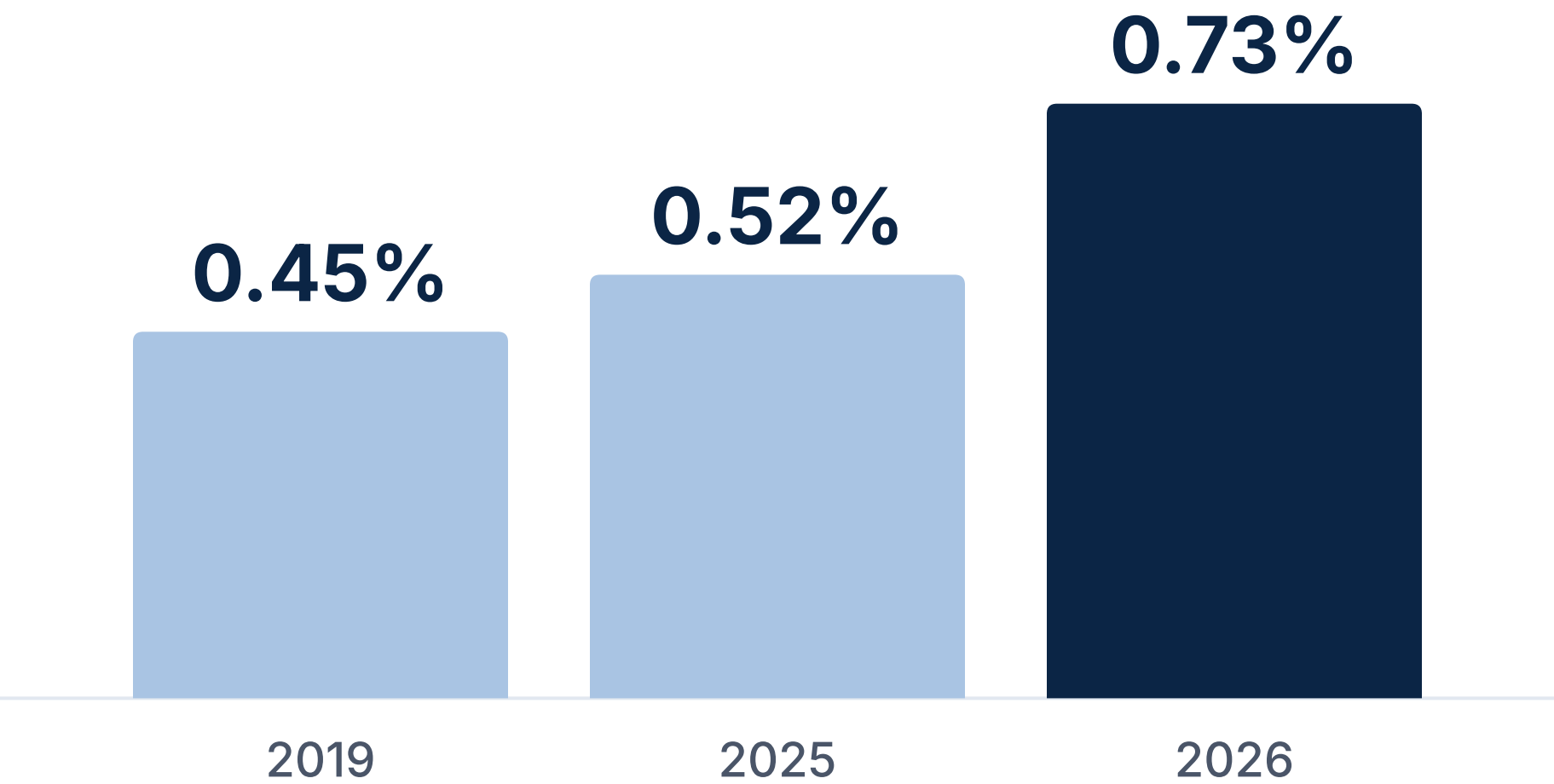
Young college grads' unemployment is up 1.5 points since 2019



Unemployment rate, ages 22–27 with a bachelor's degree or higher, January–August average, not seasonally adjusted. Change vs. 2019 exceeds our approximate 90% margin of error; change vs. 2025 does not. Source: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata.

6 · IMMIGRATION

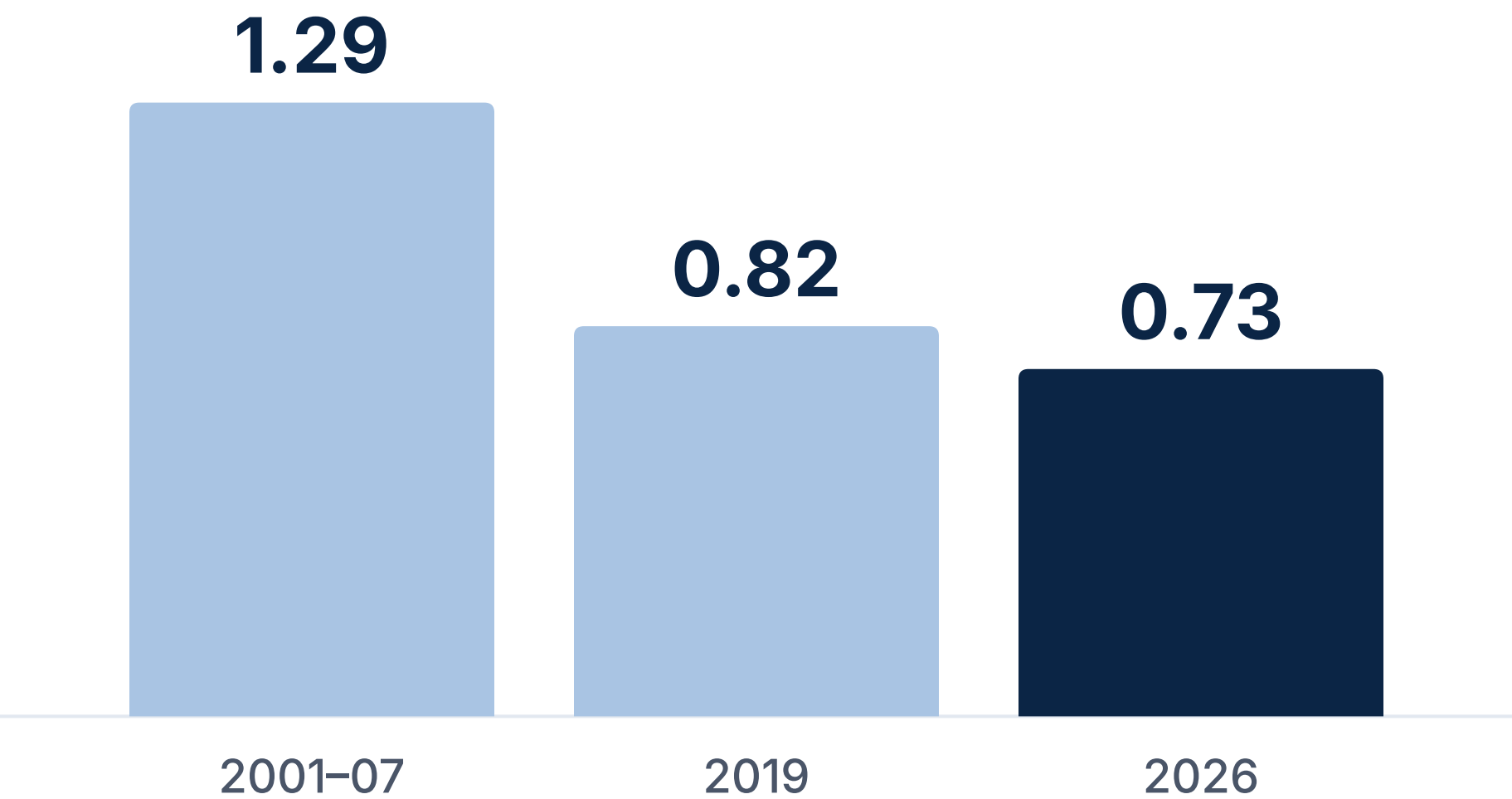
Long searches rose among U.S.-born professionals



U.S.-born white-collar workers unemployed 27+ weeks, % of their labor force, January–August average, not seasonally adjusted. Change vs 2025 exceeds its 90% margin of error. The noncitizen share of the white-collar workforce held at 6.3%, so new immigration does not explain the rise. Source: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata.

7 · HIRING

Each job opening now yields fewer hires



Hires per job opening: annual average monthly hires divided by job openings, seasonally adjusted (2001-07 average; 2026 = January-August). Hires and openings are not matched one to one. Source: BLS JOLTS; NextChapter calculation.

8 · THE GOOD NEWS

Demand for experience is holding up in places

Senior job postings rose 14.7% over the year while entry-level postings fell 7.5% (Indeed Hiring Lab).

The white-collar unemployment rate is still low, 2.7%, roughly half the blue-collar rate.

Most professionals who lose a job still find one. The problem is how long it takes, especially after 50.

Unemployment rates: NextChapter analysis of Census CPS microdata, January–August 2026. Postings: Indeed Hiring Lab, year to May 2026.

FREE · MONTHLY · WITH MARGINS OF ERROR

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15 chapters: layoffs and AI, long searches, immigration, older workers, colleges and retraining, states and more.

Free report → link in comments

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